

RetailzPOS Flagship Benchmark Report — Groundwork

Prepared: July 2026 **Status:** Planning/methodology document, not the report itself. Producing the actual report requires real data pulled from RetailzPOS's install base — this document scopes what to pull, how, and the distribution plan, so that step can happen with a clear spec rather than starting from scratch.

Why this report

Confirmed twice now in this repo's research: **no vertical-specific POS or loyalty benchmark data exists publicly for independent liquor, convenience, or smoke-shop retail**. The Moolah Points market research found this gap for loyalty specifically; the KORONA POS deep dive confirmed no competitor — including KORONA, whose content strategy is otherwise the most sophisticated in this niche — has filled it either. Whoever publishes real, credible data here first owns the citation. That's the entire strategic case: this isn't content marketing in the usual sense, it's building the source other people (and AI answer engines) end up citing.

Working title: *The State of Independent Retail POS 2026* — covering liquor, convenience, and smoke shop operators specifically. (Alternative: split into three shorter vertical reports if the data supports it better than one combined report — decide once real data volume is known.)

What this needs internally before it can ship

Be direct about the dependency: this report requires someone with access to RetailzPOS's aggregate, anonymized install-base data to pull the actual numbers below. Nothing in this document should be treated as real data — it's the spec for what to request, not a placeholder to quietly fill with invented figures.

First internal question to answer: does current data volume support a statistically meaningful full report, or should this ship as an "early look" (3-5 headline stats) first, with the full version following once more merchants have enough transaction history? KORONA's own case study is a useful precedent here — momentum mattered more than completeness for them too.

Proposed data points (pull and validate internally before publishing any of these)

Organized by section, each with the *type* of finding to look for — not fabricated numbers:

1. Inventory & shrinkage

- Average shrinkage rate by vertical (liquor vs. convenience vs. smoke shop), if distinguishable in the data
- Most common cause of inventory discrepancy (case-break miscounts vs. theft vs. record-keeping error) — ties directly to the earlier RetailzPOS social content already built around the "1-4% of revenue lost to shrinkage, 20% from bad record-keeping" c-store statistic; a proprietary version of that same finding, specific to RetailzPOS merchants, would be a strong opening stat
- Average time between "low stock" flag and reorder, comparing merchants using AI reorder alerts vs. those who aren't

2. Compliance & age verification

- Rate of flagged/declined age-restricted transactions across the install base (ties directly to the hard-block/soft-block compliance guide already published — this would be the proprietary data point that guide is currently missing)
- Adoption rate of hard-block vs. soft-block configuration, if both are supported and trackable
- Any anonymized aggregate on ID-scan mismatch/decline frequency

3. Loyalty & repeat business (cross-reference with Moolah Points data if the two products share reporting infrastructure)

- Average check-lift for loyalty-enrolled customers vs. non-enrolled, by vertical
- Return-visit rate after the 2nd, 3rd, 4th visit — a proprietary version of the Paytronix "95% after visit 4" stat already used in Moolah's content, but from RetailzPOS's own merchants specifically
- SMS vs. email engagement rates within the install base

4. Payments & checkout

- Contactless/tap-to-pay adoption rate among RetailzPOS merchants
- Average transaction time, if measurable

5. Multi-location & operational

- Share of merchants operating 2+ locations
- Most common reason merchants cite for switching to RetailzPOS from a previous POS (this could be pulled from onboarding/sales notes rather than transaction data, and would directly validate or complicate the comparison-content claims already published)

Format & gating

Mirrors the approach already scoped for Moolah's equivalent report: - Publish 2-3 headline stats **ungated**, to drive shares and press pickup - Gate the full report behind email/phone capture — this becomes a direct lead-gen asset, not just a PR play - Design as a clean, citable PDF/web page with clear sourcing methodology stated upfront (sample size, date range, anonymization method) — credibility here matters more than for ordinary blog content, since the entire point is becoming a citable source

Distribution plan

Directly reuses the real, confirmed trade press targets from the guest-posting strategy: - Pitch **Retail Dive** and **CSP Daily News / Convenience Store News / Beverage Dynamics** for an exclusive first-look ahead of general publication — same tactic already recommended for Moolah's version of this report - Once published, this becomes the natural subject of the Retail Dive op-ed or Retail TouchPoints Executive ViewPoints piece already planned — "what we learned from our own merchant data" is a stronger, more citable angle than a generic trend piece - Feed the headline stats into the comparison/review content already published (the age-verification compliance guide, in particular, would get materially stronger with a real proprietary stat backing the hard-block/soft-block argument instead of only third-party sources)

Where this sits in the 90-day plan

Matches Days 61-90 in `retailzpos-content-seo-backlink-hybrid-strategy-2026-07.md` : ship full or "early look" version, pitch trade press for exclusive coverage, then fold the findings back into the comparison-content library and compliance guide as updated, strengthened citations.

Next step

This document is ready to hand to whoever owns product/data access — the ask is: can we pull anonymized, aggregate versions of the data points in Section 1-5 above, and at what sample size/confidence level? That answer determines whether this ships as a full report or an early-look version first.